

The Canon for the Departed - Tone VI

Ode I

Irmos: Traversing the deep on foot, as though it were dry land, * and seeing the tyrant Pharaoh drowned, * Israel cried aloud: * Let us sing unto God a hymn of victory!

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints the God of Israel.

In the heavenly mansion the valiant martyrs continually pray unto Thee, O Christ. Vouchsafe the faithful whom Thou hast translated from the earth to obtain eternal good things.

Refrain: Give rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy servants who have fallen asleep.

Thou Who adornest all things hast created me, a human creature, a mixture of the lowly and the exalted together. Wherefore, give rest, O Saviour, to the soul of Thy servant.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit. A citizen and husbandman of paradise didst Thou create me in the beginning; but when I transgressed Thy commandment Thou didst drive me forth. Wherefore, give rest, O Saviour, to the soul of Thy servant.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen. He Who aforetime fashioned Eve our first mother from a rib, clothed Himself in flesh from thy most pure womb, O most pure one, by which He destroyed the power of death.

Ode III

Irmos: There is none holy as Thou, O Lord my God, * Who hast exalted the horn of Thy faithful, O Good One, * and hast established us upon the rock * of Thy confession.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints the God of Israel.

Thy martyrs did strive lawfully, O Life-giver, and having been adorned with the crown of victory, they fervently intercede that those departed in faith be granted eternal redemption.

Refrain: Give rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy servants who have fallen asleep.

Having with many signs and wonders first chastened me who had gone astray, at the last Thou didst empty Thyself, as a co-sufferer, and seeking didst find and save.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.
O Good One, vouchsafe him (*her*) who hath come to Thee from the corruption of changeable, fleeting things to live joyfully in eternal tabernacles, having justified him (*her*) by faith and grace.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

There is none blameless as thou, O most pure Mother of God, for thou alone out of the ages didst conceive in thy womb the true God, Who hath destroyed the power of death.

Katavasia: There is none holy as Thou, O Lord my God, * Who hast exalted the horn of Thy faithful, O Good One, * and hast established us upon the rock * of Thy confession.

Then the Requiem Litany is chanted, during which the departed are commemorated by name.

The Requiem Litany

DEACON: Again and again, let us pray to the Lord.

CHANTERS: Lord, have mercy.

DEACON: Again we pray for the repose of the departed servants of God, N.N., and that they may be forgiven every transgression, both voluntary and involuntary. *Refrain.*

DEACON: That the Lord God commit their souls to where the righteous repose. *Refrain.*

DEACON: The mercy of God, the kingdom of Heaven, and the remission of their sins, let us ask of Christ the Immortal King and our God.

CHANTERS: Grant this, O Lord.

DEACON: Let us pray to the Lord

CHANTERS: Lord, have mercy. *Forty Times.*

The priest saith this prayer secretly:

O God of spirits and of all flesh, Who hast trampled down death, and overthrown the devil, and given life to Thy world: Do Thou Thyself, O Lord, give rest to the souls of Thy departed servants, *N.N.*, in a place of light, a place of green pasture, a place of repose, whence all sickness, sorrow and sighing are fled away. Pardon every sin committed by them in word, deed, or thought, in that Thou art a good God, the Lover of mankind; for there is no man that liveth and sinneth not, for Thou alone art without sin, Thy righteousness is an everlasting righteousness, and Thy word is truth.

Before the exclamation, the deacon hands the censer to the priest, and he censens as he says the exclamation.

PRIEST: For Thou art the Resurrection, and the life, and the repose of Thy departed servants *N.N.*, O Christ our God, and unto Thee do we send up glory, together with Thine unoriginate Father, and Thy most holy and good and life-creating Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. **CHANTERS:** Amen.

Sessional Hymns

Sessional Hymns, in Tone VI —

Truly all things are vanity * and life is but a shadow and a dream, *
for in vain doth every one born of earth disquiet himself, * as saith
the Scripture; * when we have acquired the world, * then do we take
up our abode in the grave, * where together are both kings and
beggars. * Wherefore, O Christ God, give rest to the departed, * as
Thou art the Lover of mankind.

Glory... Both now... *Theotokion* —

O all-holy Theotokos, * throughout my lifetime forsake me not, * to
human protection entrust me not, * but do thou thyself protect and
have mercy on me.

Ode IV

Irmos: Christ is my power, my God and my Lord, * doth the august Church sing in godly fashion, * and she crieth out with a pure mind, * keeping festival in the Lord.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints the God of Israel.

Revealing a complete understanding of wisdom, and a full perfection of goodness through gifts, O Master, Thou didst number the company of martyrs with the choir of angels.

Refrain: Give rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy servants who have fallen asleep.

Vouchsafe him (*her*) who hath been translated unto Thee, O Christ, to obtain Thine ineffable glory, where there is the abode of them that make glad, and the pure voice of rejoicing.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit. Him (*her*) who singeth of Thy divine dominion, whom Thou hast taken away from the earth, do Thou receive, making him (*her*) a child of light, cleansing him (*her*) from the darkness of sin, O Thou Who art plenteous in mercy.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.
O receptacle most pure, O spotless temple, O ark all-holy, O virgin mercy-seat: the Master hath chosen thee, the beauty of Jacob.

Ode V

Irmos: With Thy divine light, O Good One, * illumine the souls of them that rise early to pray to Thee with love, * I pray that they may know Thee, O Word of God, * as the true God, * Who calleth all forth from the darkness of sin.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints the God of Israel.

As holy fruits, and as the first fruits of human nature, the martyrs, having offered themselves for the glory of God, ever intercede for our salvation.

Refrain: Give rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy servants who have fallen asleep.

A heavenly abode, a distribution of gifts, vouchsafe, O Lord, unto Thy faithful servant departed before us, granting him *(her)* redemption from sins.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.
O Thou Who alone art by nature the Life-creator, Who art truly a fathomless abyss of goodness, vouchsafe Thy kingdom to him *(her)* who hath reposed, O Compassionate, Only Immortal One.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.
He Who was born of thee, O Lady, is become the strength and the song, and the salvation of those who perish, delivering from the gates of hell those who with faith bless thee.

Ode VI

Irmos: Beholding the sea of life * surging with the tempest of temptations, * I run to Thy calm haven and cry unto Thee: * Raise up my life from corruption, * O greatly Merciful One!

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints the God of Israel.

When Thou was nailed to the Cross, Thou didst gather unto Thyself the choirs of the martyrs who followed the example of Thy Passion, O Good One. Wherefore, we pray Thee: Give rest unto him *(her)* who hath no departed unto Thee.

Refrain: Give rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy servants who have fallen asleep.

When Thou comest awesomely on the clouds in Thine ineffable glory to judge the whole world, deign, O Redeemer, that Thy faithful servant who Thou hast taken from the earth may meet Thee joyfully.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Thou who art the Fountain of life, O Master, Who mightily ledest forth the captive through Thy divinity, do Thou settle in the sweetness of paradise Thy servant who in faith hath departed unto Thee.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

We have returned back to the earth, having apostatized from the divine commandments of God, but through thee, O Virgin, we have ascended from earth to heaven, having shaken off the corruption of death.

Katavasia: Beholding the sea of life * surging with the tempest of temptations, * I run to Thy calm haven and cry unto Thee: * Raise up my life from corruption, * O greatly Merciful One!

*Then the Requiem Litany is chanted, during which the departed are commemorated by name.
The censing during the Litany is performed as at the previous litany.*

The Requiem Litany

DEACON: Again and again, let us pray to the Lord.

CHANTERS: Lord, have mercy.

DEACON: Again we pray for the repose of the departed servants of God, N.N., and that they may be forgiven every transgression, both voluntary and involuntary. *Refrain.*

DEACON: That the Lord God commit their souls to where the righteous repose. *Refrain.*

DEACON: The mercy of God, the kingdom of Heaven, and the remission of their sins, let us ask of Christ the Immortal King and our God.

CHANTERS: Grant this, O Lord.

DEACON: Let us pray to the Lord

CHANTERS: Lord, have mercy. *Forty Times.*

The priest saith this prayer secretly:

O God of spirits and of all flesh, Who hast trampled down death, and overthrown the devil, and given life to Thy world: Do Thou Thyself, O Lord, give rest to the souls of Thy departed servants, *N.N.*, in a place of light, a place of green pasture, a place of repose, whence all sickness, sorrow and sighing are fled away. Pardon every sin committed by them in word, deed, or thought, in that Thou art a good God, the Lover of mankind; for there is no man that liveth and sinneth not, for Thou alone art without sin, Thy righteousness is an everlasting righteousness, and Thy word is truth.

Before the exclamation, the deacon hands the censer to the priest, and he censes as he says the exclamation.

PRIEST: For Thou art the Resurrection, and the life, and the repose of Thy departed servants N.N., O Christ our God, and unto Thee do we send up glory, together with Thine unoriginate Father, and Thy most holy and good and life-creating Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. **CHANTERS:** Amen.

During the singing of the kontakion and ikos, the deacon performs the small censuring.

Kontakion for the Departed, in Tone VIII —

With the saints give rest, * O Christ, * to the souls of Thy servants, * where there is neither sickness, nor sorrow, nor sighing, * but life everlasting.

Ikos:

Thou alone art immortal, * Who didst create and fashion man; * but we mortals were formed of earth, * and unto earth shall we return, * as Thou who madest me didst command and say unto me: * For earth thou art and unto earth shalt thou return, * whither all we mortals are going, * making as a funeral dirge the song: * Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia.

Ode VII

Irmos: An angel made the furnace sprinkle dew upon the righteous youths. * But the command of God consumed the Chaldeans * and prevailed upon the tyrant to cry: * Blessed art Thou, O God of our Fathers.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints the God of Israel.

Redeemed from the first transgression by Thy Blood, the martyrs, having been sprinkled with their own blood, plainly typify Thy sacrifice. Blessed art Thou, O God of our fathers.

Refrain: Give rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy servants who have fallen asleep.

Thou didst slay Death the insolent, O Word, Master of Life; accept now him (*her*) who hath fallen asleep in faith, hymning Thee and saying: O Christ, blessed art Thou, O God of our fathers.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Having ensouled me, a mortal, with Thy breath divine, O Master having divine power, do Thou vouchsafe Thy kingdom unto the departed, that he (*she*) may hymn Thee, O Saviour; Blessed art Thou, O God of our fathers.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Higher than all creation didst thou become, O most-blameless one, when thou didst conceive God Who destroyed the gates and burst the bars of death; wherefore, we faithful magnify thee, O pure one, as the Mother of God.

Ode VIII

Irmos: From the flame Thou didst sprinkle dew upon the saints, * and didst burn the sacrifice of a righteous man which was sprinkled with water. * For Thou alone, O Christ dost do all as Thou willest. * Thee do we exalt unto all ages.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints the God of Israel.

Having been proved steadfast in the struggle, O martyrs, ye have been adorned with the crown of victory, O passion-bearers, crying: Thee do we supremely exalt, O Christ, unto the ages.

Refrain: Give rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy servants who have fallen asleep.

The faithful who have departed life in a holy manner and have come unto Thee, the Master, do thou kindly receive, as Thou art compassionate, giving rest to those who supremely exalt Thee unto all ages.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Graciously vouchsafe, O Saviour, to establish now in the land of the meek all those who have fallen asleep before us, who having been justified through faith in thee and through grace exalt thee unto all the ages.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

We all bless thee, O all-blessed one, who gavest birth to the Word Who is truly blessed, Who became flesh for our sake; Whom we supremely exalt unto all ages.

We praise, we bless, we worship the Lord, praising and supremely exalting Him unto all ages.

Katavasia: From the flame Thou didst sprinkle dew upon the saints, * and didst burn the sacrifice of a righteous man which was sprinkled with water. * For Thou alone, O Christ dost do all as Thou willest. * Thee do we exalt unto all ages.

Ode IX

DEACON: The Theotokos and Mother of the Light let us magnify in song..

CHANTERS: The spirits and the souls of the righteous praise Thee, O Lord.

Irmos: It is not possible for men to see God, * upon Whom the ranks of angels dare not gaze; * but through thee, O all-pure one, * appeared to men the Word incarnate, * Whom magnifying, * with the heavenly hosts * we call thee blessed.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints the God of Israel.

Hope made strong the choirs of martyrs, and enflamed them toward Thy love, prefiguring to them truly the unchanging rest of the life to come; which, O Good One, do Thou vouchsafe the departed faithful to attain.

Refrain: Give rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy servants who have fallen asleep.

Be pleased, O Christ, that he (*she*) who hath departed in faith may attain unto Thy bright and divine radiance, giving him (*her*) repose in the bosom of Abraham, for Thou alone art merciful, and do Thou vouchsafe eternal blessedness.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.
O Thou Who art by nature good and compassionate, and willest mercy and art an abyss of loving-kindness; him (*her*), O Saviour, whom Thou hast translated from this place of affliction and the shadow of death, do Thou settle where Thy light shineth.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

A holy tabernacle we understand thee to be, O pure one, and an ark, and a tablet of the law of grace; for through thee is forgiveness granted unto those who are justified by the Blood of Him Who was incarnate of thy womb, O all-spotless one.

Katavasia: It is not possible for men to see God, * upon Whom the ranks of angels dare not gaze; * but through thee, O all-pure one, * appeared to men the Word incarnate, * Whom magnifying, * with the heavenly hosts * we call thee blessed.

<http://www.orthodox.net/services/canon-for-the-departed.doc>

<http://www.orthodox.net/services/canon-for-the-departed.pdf>